

The pharma states

How big is the pharmaceutical industry inside a national economy — and what does each country actually make?

- 42 countries
- 35 years
- Eurostat · OECD · trade

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One number hides three questions.

How big?

Pharma's share of the whole economy

How concentrated?

How much of one economy rides on it

What kind?

Biologics, pills, or raw ingredients

Answer all three and the same industry looks completely different.

SURPRISE 1 · HOW BIG

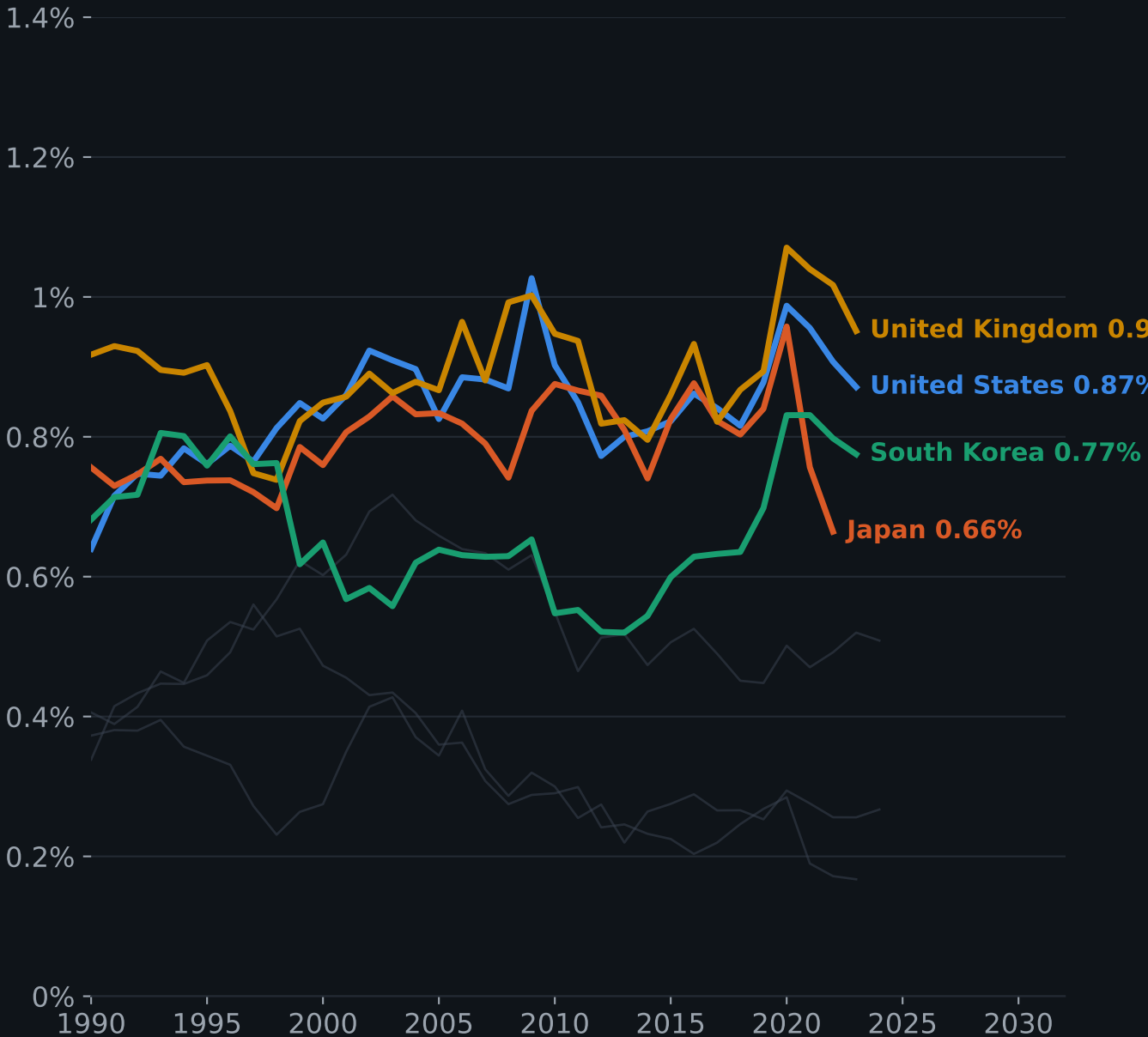
≈ 1%

Every large economy holds pharma manufacturing near 1% of GDP — and has for thirty years.

United States	0.87%
United Kingdom	0.95%
Japan	0.66%
Germany	0.67%

THIRTY YEARS, ONE BAND

The big economies never move



Pharma value added ÷ total value added, 1990→. Grey: other economies.

The exceptions aren't big.

They're small economies that let one industry become the economy.

16.7%

Ireland

of the whole economy

8.7%

Denmark

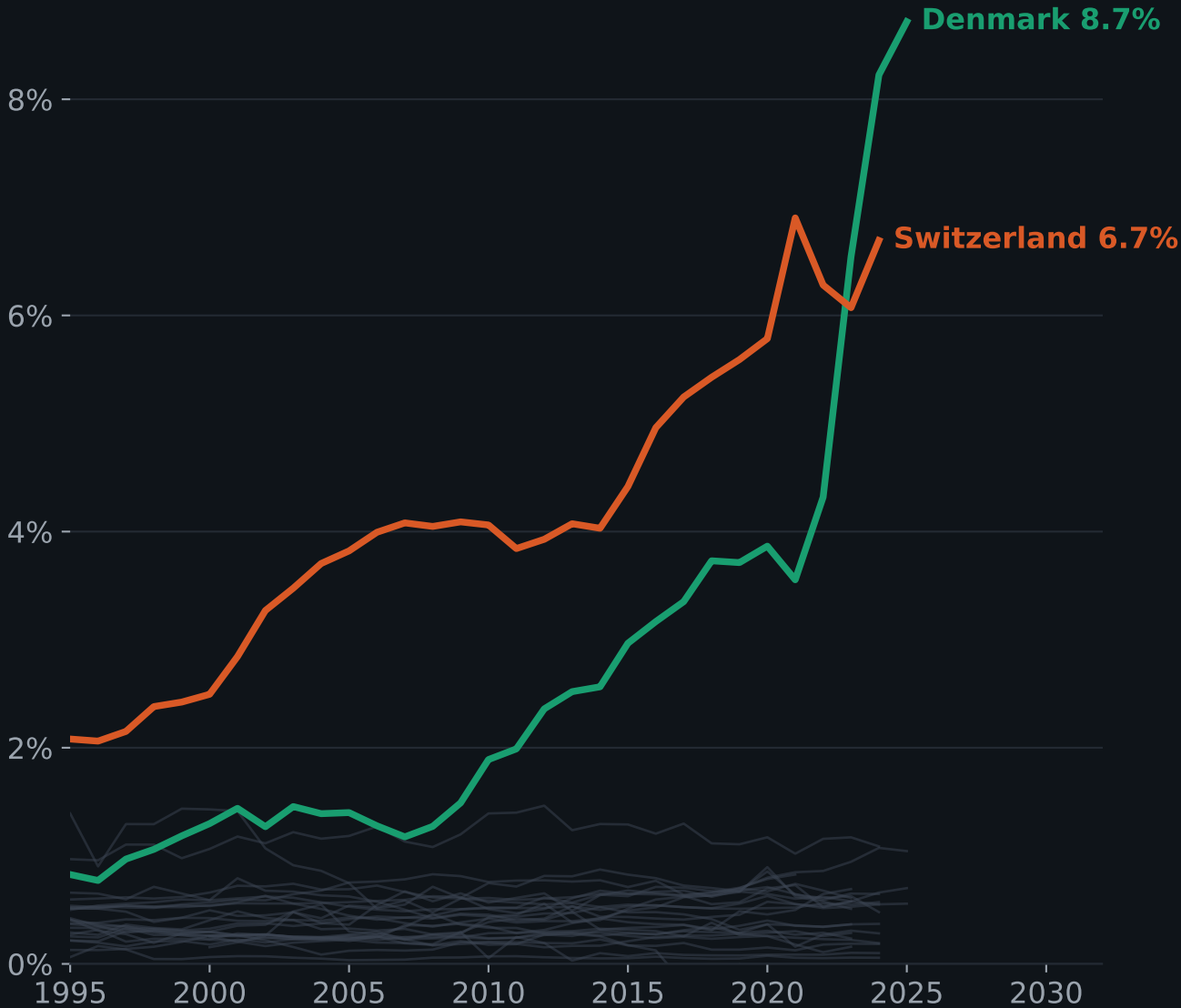
and ~49% of all manufacturing

6.7%

Switzerland

ONE COUNTRY, ONE INDUSTRY

Denmark: 0.8% → 8.7% of GDP



Pharma ÷ GDP, 1995→2025. Grey: 25 other European countries.

Same industry. Same €value.

In 2023 Germany and Denmark each produced ~€25bn of pharma.

Germany

€26bn

0.6% of GDP

a rounding error

Denmark

€24bn

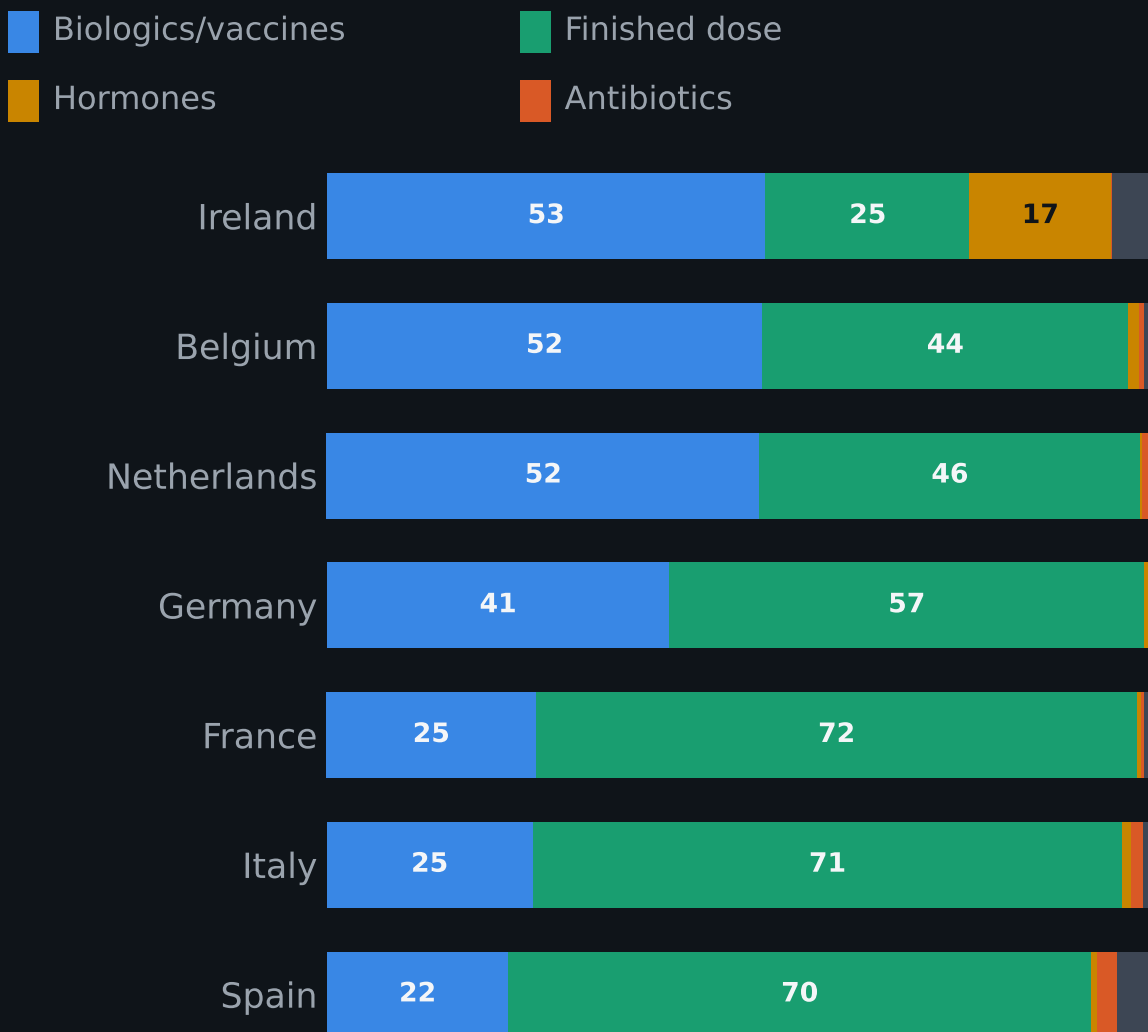
6.5% of GDP

the growth engine

Concentration, not pharma, is the phenomenon.

SURPRISE 3 · WHAT KIND

Two industries hide inside “pharma”

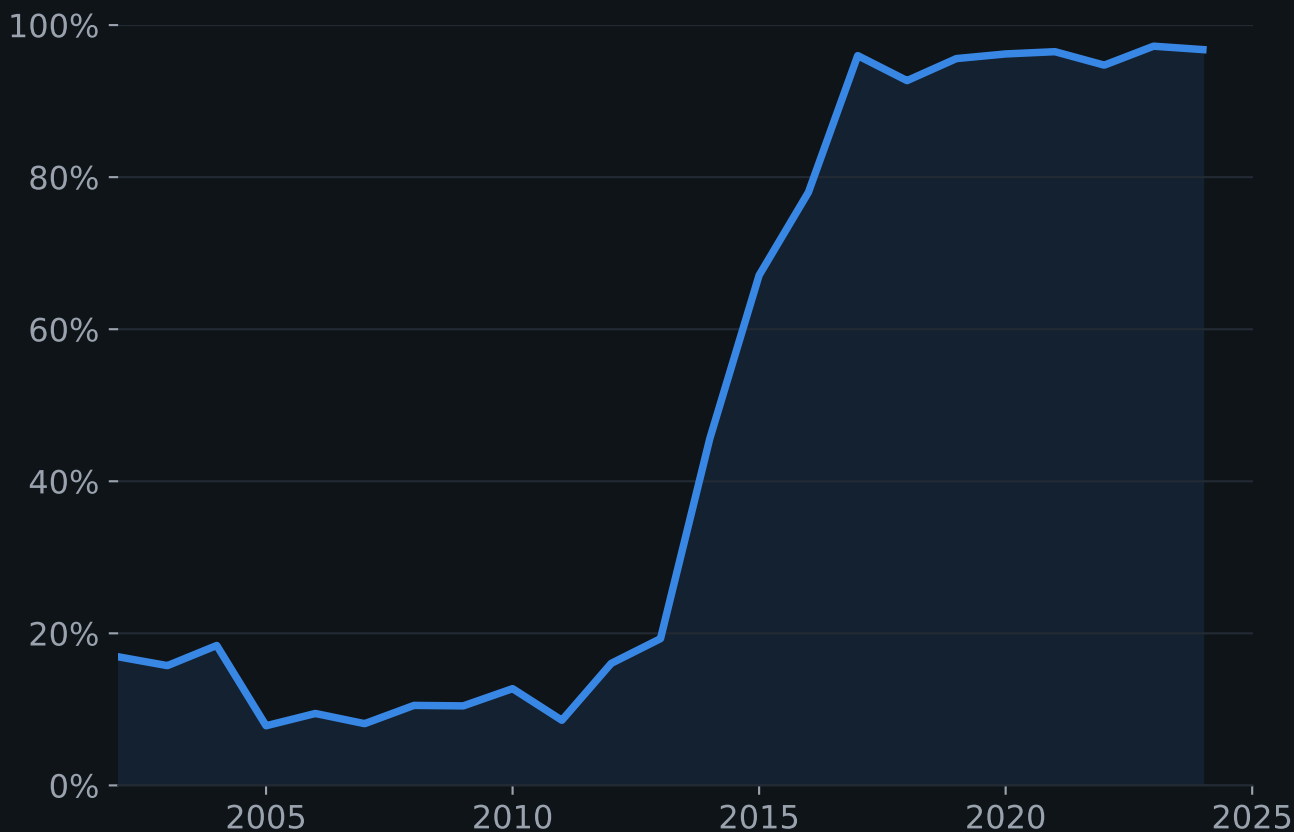


Biologics-led (Ireland, Belgium) vs finished-pill-led (France, Italy). Export mix by product class, 2024.

THE KICKER

97%

of what South Korea now
ships to the EU is biologics



Up from under 20% in 2013 — Samsung Biologics and Celltrion
coming online. A national bet, visible in customs data first.

Big. Concentrated. Or strategic.

The same industry is a rounding error in one country, a national growth engine in another, and a bet on the future in a third.

■ Türkiye

0.35% of GDP, flat for two decades — while Korea, a fair peer, built biosimilar champions from a similar start. The gap is strategy, not statistics.

Full study · 42 countries · open data pipeline

namikakmandev.github.io/pharma-gdp-share.html

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